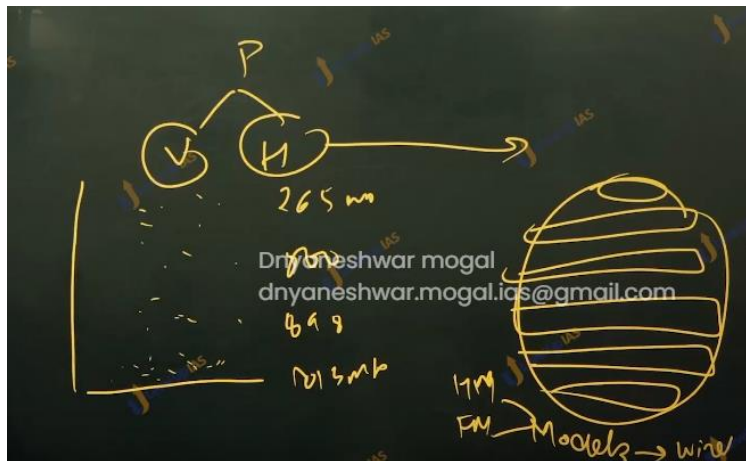


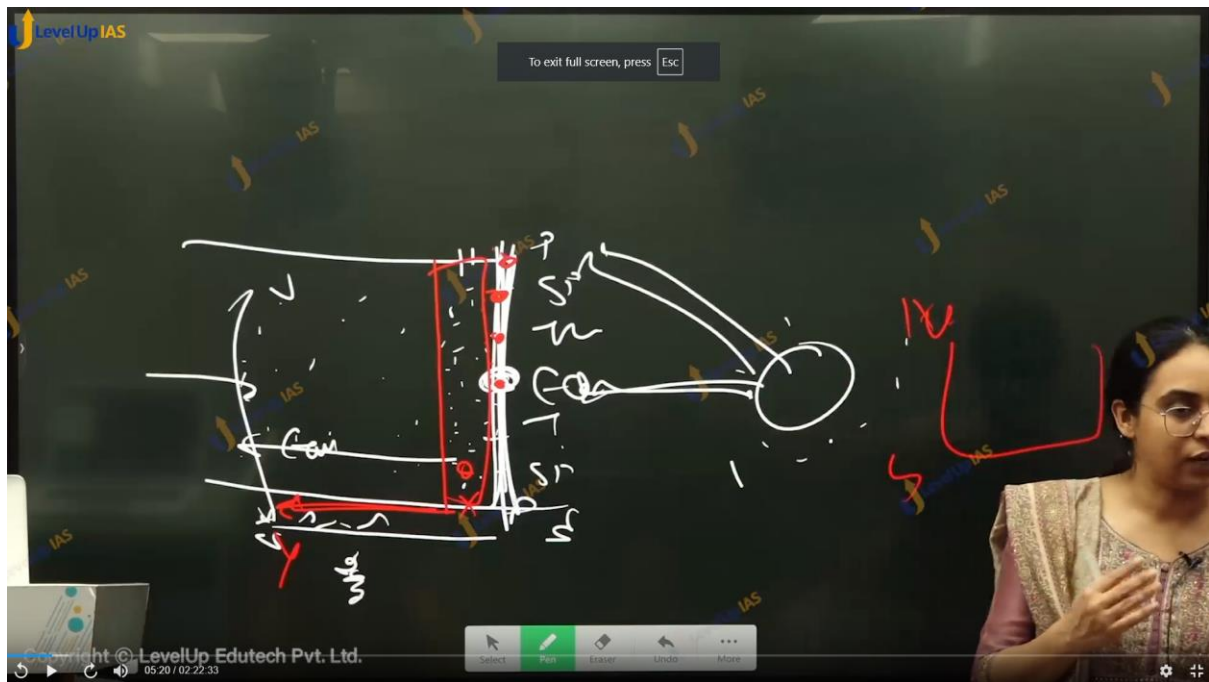


- 1) There are 7 pressure variations.

- 2) There are 2 types of pressure variation horizontal, and vertical. Near the sea level there is more atmospheric pressure while the pressure decreases with the increases in height.
- 3) At zero km (sea level) height the pressure is about 1013 mb at 1 km it about 898 mb at 10 km the pressure is 256 mb.
- 4) There are also horizontal pressure variations on the surface of the earth which can be understood with the various models.
- 5) It is important to understand pressure variations as affects the movement of air and winds. pressures that determines whether there would be vertical movement or not.
- 6)

There



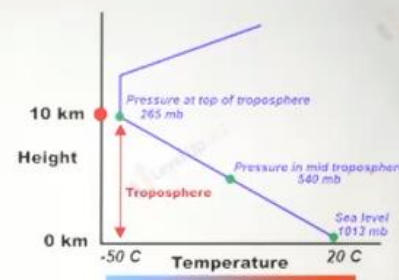


Pressure Variation and Circulation

- Variation in Atmospheric pressure results in movement of wind from high pressure to low pressure
- Atmospheric pressure determines whether air packet will rise or fall.
- Vertical rising of air cools and causes instability and precipitation.

• Pressure Gradient:

- **Vertical Pressure Gradient:** Near Sea Level is more atm pressure while pressure decreases with height.
- **Horizontal Pressure Gradient:** Lets Understand Various Models



Level	Pressure in mb
Sea Level	1,013.25
1 km	898.76
5 km	540.48
10 km	265.00

Surface pressure variation.

To understand surface pressure variation certain models have been developed. Models represent the simplification of reality, therefore, to simplify reality there are certain assumptions. Two famous models are

1. Hadley model / unicellular model.
2. Ferrel's model (tricellular model).

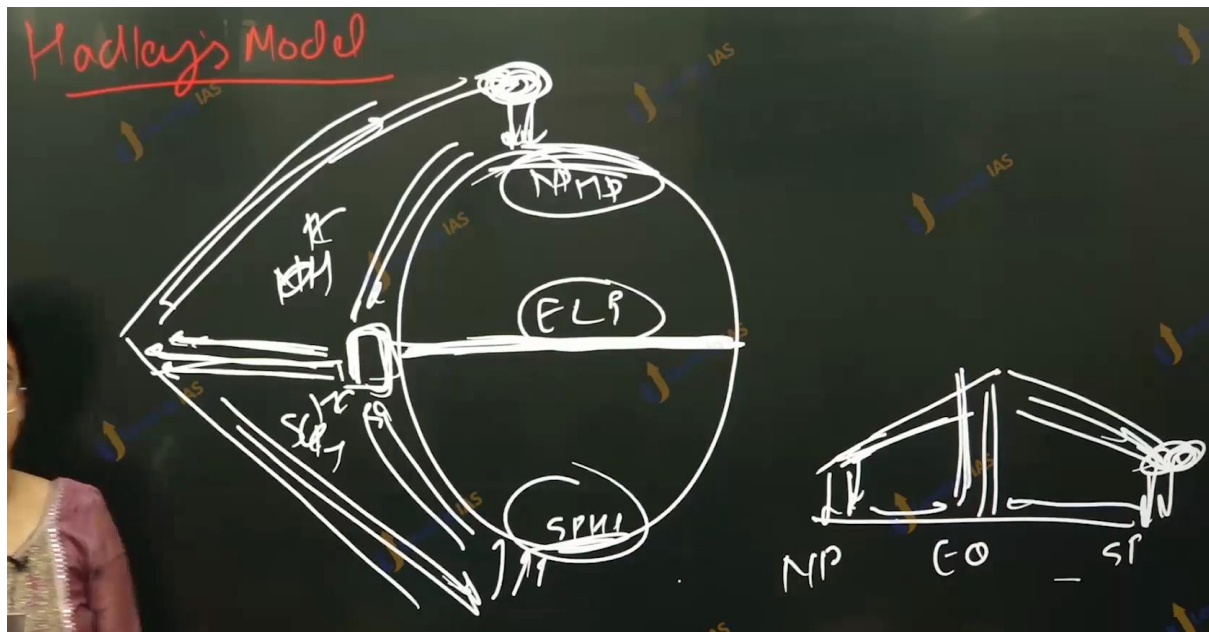
Hardey's model:

Hardey involved two assumptions:

1. Homogeneous surface that is no land water differentials
2. Nonrotating earth. Therefore, it does not account for Coriolis force.
- 3.

Model:

1. The equator is warm, the air above the equator becomes warm and rises up to tropopause. The air after reaching tropopause gets deflected towards the poles. On reaching at the poles the air cools and start sinking. This leads to the air moving from poles to equator. As per hardly there are 3 pressure belts on the surface of earth 1. Equatoria low pressure belt 2. Two polar high-pressure belt and there is one shell per hemisphere therefore, it models called unicellular model.



Atmospheric circulation model:

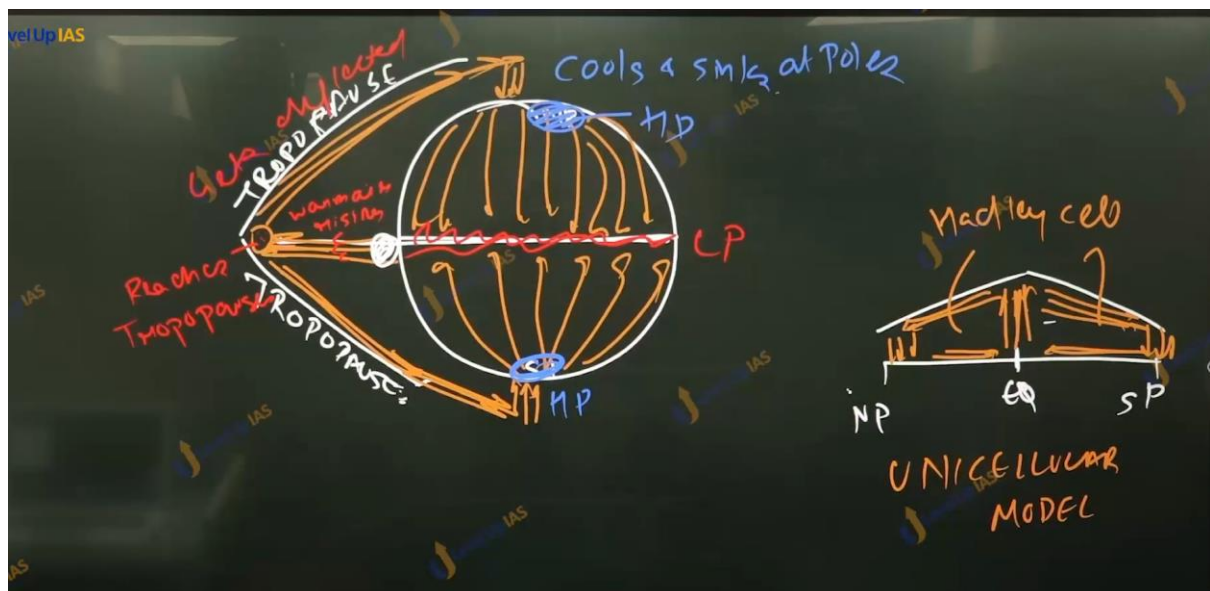
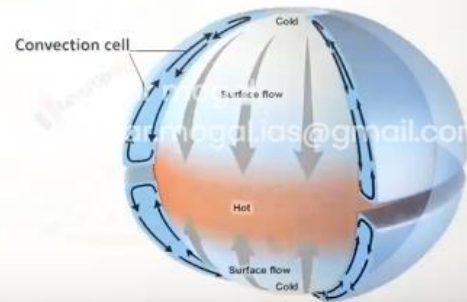
Model represents simplification of reality

Hadley's Model/ Unicellular Model

1. Assumption: Homogenous Surface, Non Rotating Earth (so did not account for Coriolis force)
2. Model:
 - Equator is warm
 - Warm air rises upto tropopause
 - Air after reaching at tropopause moves towards poles
 - Once air reaches at poles, it cools and so start sinking. Air after reaching at the surface, air moves towards Equator
 - There are 3 pressure cell: 1 ELPB, 2 PHPB
 - There is one cell per hemisphere: Uni



- Earth is round but not smooth
- Coriolis force ??????
- Land and water contrast ????



2. Tricellular model:

a. Assumption:

- i. Homogenous surface and rotating earth (he accounted for Coriolis force)

b. Model

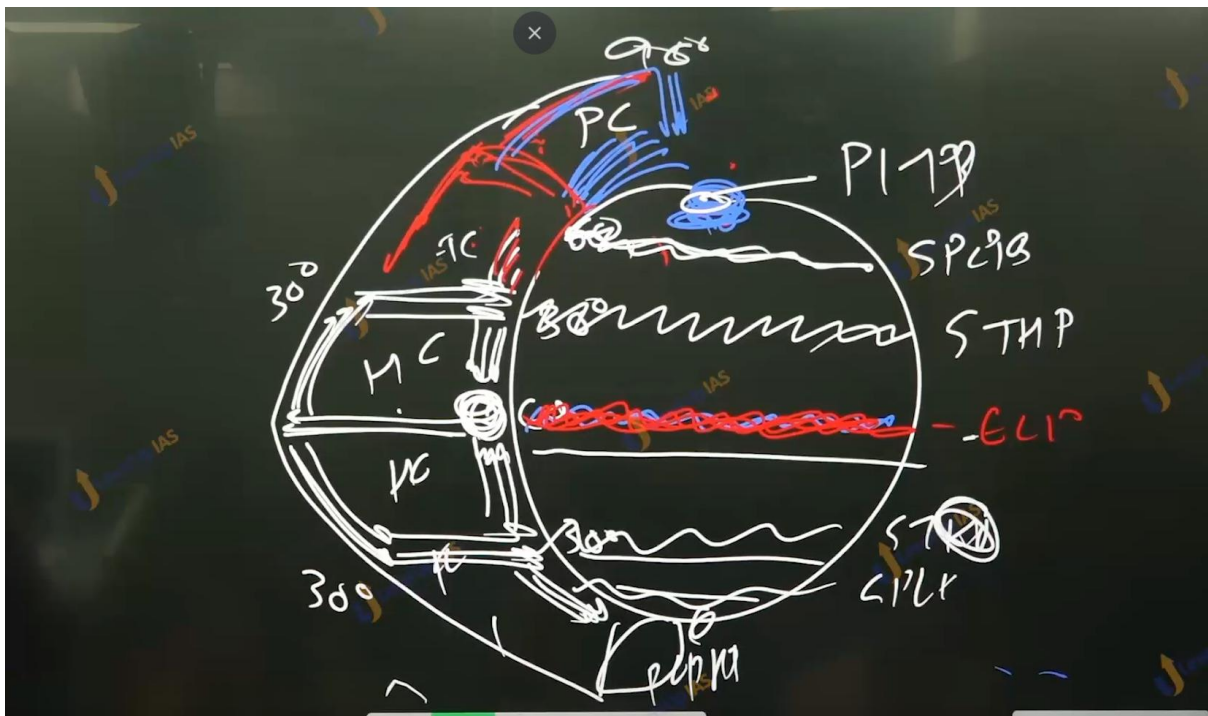
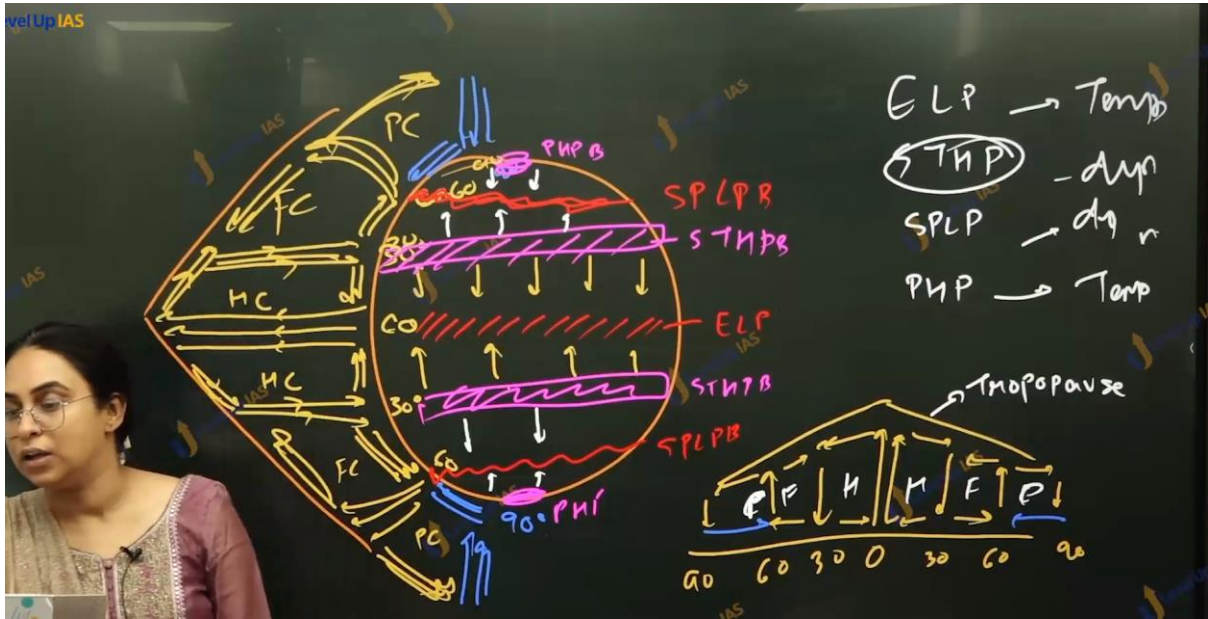
- i. There was a dramatic improvement to Hadley's model.
- ii. Along with insolation the Ferrel accounting for role of Coriolis force
- iii. As per this model warm air raises at equator and reaches tropopause and depleted towards the poles
- iv. Warm air cools when it reaches the tropopause. Above 30 degrees north or south air sinks
- v. Warm air moves from 30 degrees north from south towards 60 north south and some air packet also moved towards equator.
- vi. At 60 north or south there is interaction cooled air from the poles and warm air which has moved from the 30 degrees north or south to warm 60 degree north or south.
- vii. Warm air posted to raise up, this air on reaching tropopause gets depleted towards 30 degrees and 90 degrees
- viii. At 90 degrees the air cools and it sinks therefore, it models have 3 cell per hemisphere.
- ix. As per model there are 7 pressure belts.
 - 1. Equatorial low-pressure belt.
 - 2. 2 subtropic high-pressure belt.
 - 3. 2 subpolar low-pressure belts.
 - 4. 2 polar high-pressure belts.
 - 5.

c. Improvements of Ferrel's model / benefits of Ferrel's model.

- i. He was able to explain planetary winds like trad winds, wester leaves and polar ester leaves.
- ii. Ferrel is better able to explain the rainfall conditions at the subpolar conditions.
- iii. Ferrel is better able to explain the formation of desert at subtropic ex, Sahar desert, athames desert, thar desert, great Australian desert etc.
- iv.

d. Limitation of Ferrel's model.

- i. Upper troposphere circulation has not been currently interpreted by the Ferrel. Ferrel considers the upper tropospheric wind to be mirror opposite of surface wind. Which is not true.
- ii. The local and regional circulation has not been explained by Ferrel.
- iii. Simplistic assumptions that is land-water contrast. In reality there are pressure cells. Some pressure cells are permanent and some are seasonal pressure cells.

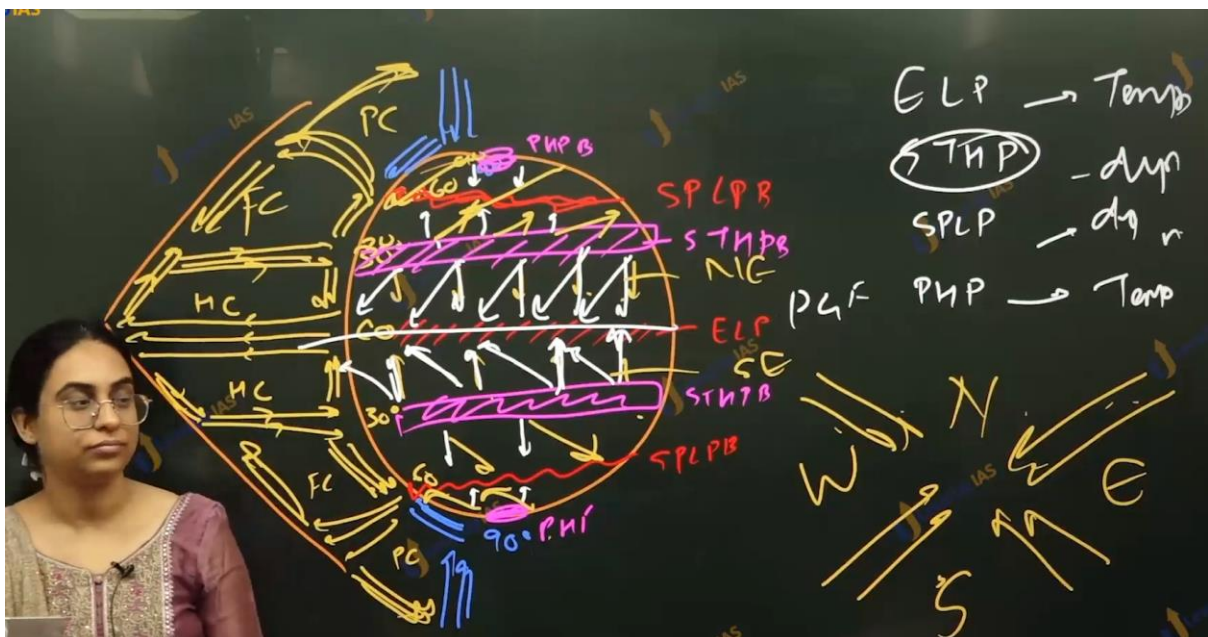
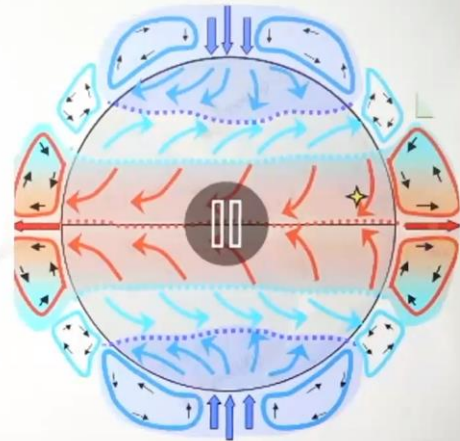


Atmospheric circulation model:

Model represents simplification of reality

Ferrel's Model/ Tricellular Model

1. Assumption: Homogenous Surface, Rotating Earth (so did account for Coriolis force)
2. Model:
 - Dramatic Improvement over Hadley's Model
 - Along with insolation, Ferrel accounted for the role of Coriolis force (Because of Earth's Rotation)

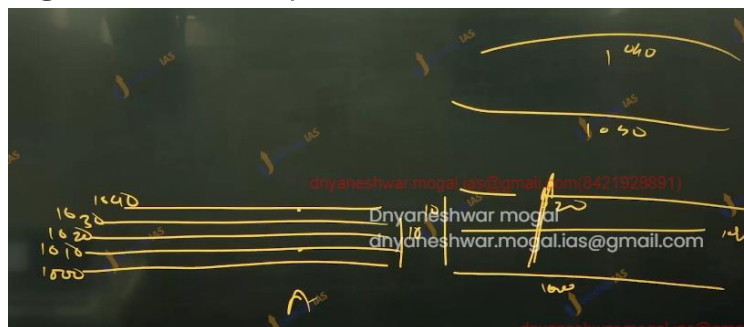


Winds:

1. Winds are horizontal movement of air from high pressure to low pressure.
 2. Wind is governed by 3 major forces
 - a. Pressure gradient force
 - b. Coriolis force
 - c. Frictional force.
-

3. Pressure gradient force:

- a. The difference in atmosphere pressure produces force. Therefore, wind blows from high pressure to low pressure.
- b. When the isobar is closely situated the pressure gradient is higher and wind speed is more.



- c.
 - d.
-

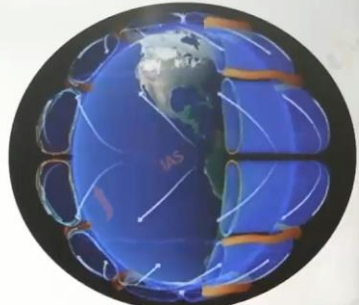
4. Coriolis force:

- a. Rotation of earth affects the direction of winds. This force was detected by French physicist and hence this force is named after him; this force is called Coriolis force.
- b. Coriolis force deflects the winds to the right in the northern hemisphere and to the left in the southern hemisphere.
- c. Coriolis force is directly proportional to the angle of latitude.
- d. Greater the angle, there greater is Coriolis force; the Coriolis forces are zero at the equator and maximum at the poles.

- e. The deflection is more when the velocity is more. higher PGF more is the velocity of wind, more is the Coriolis force the more deflection (seen in the case of upper tropospheric winds.)
-

Coriolis Force:

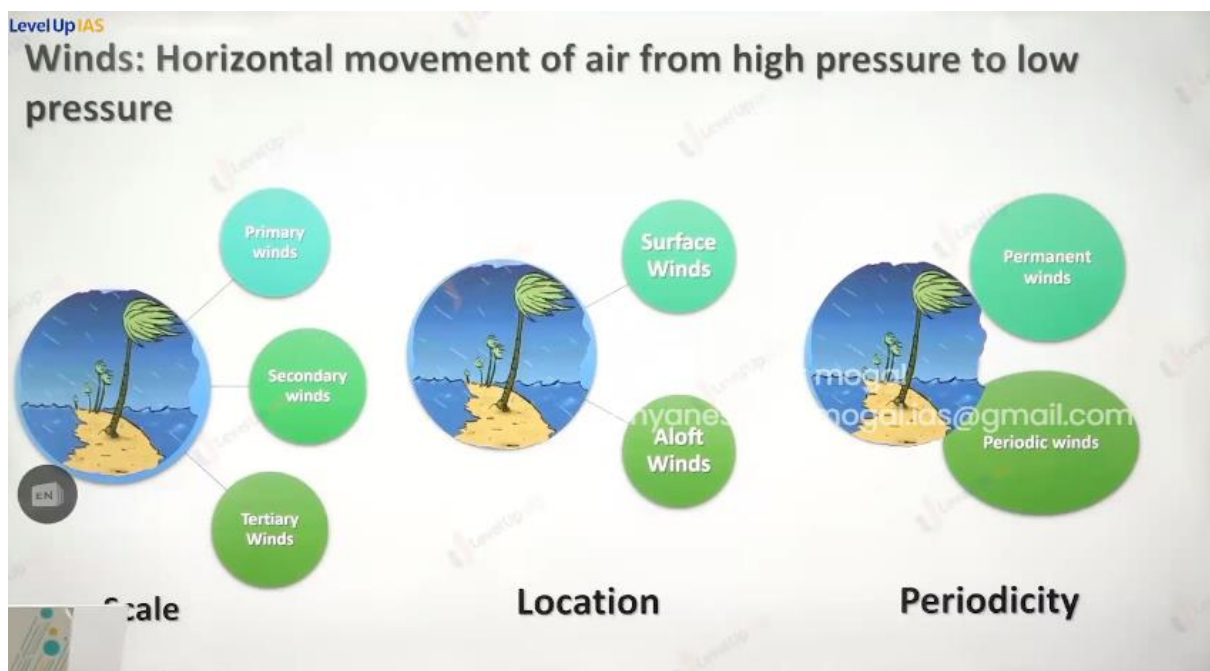
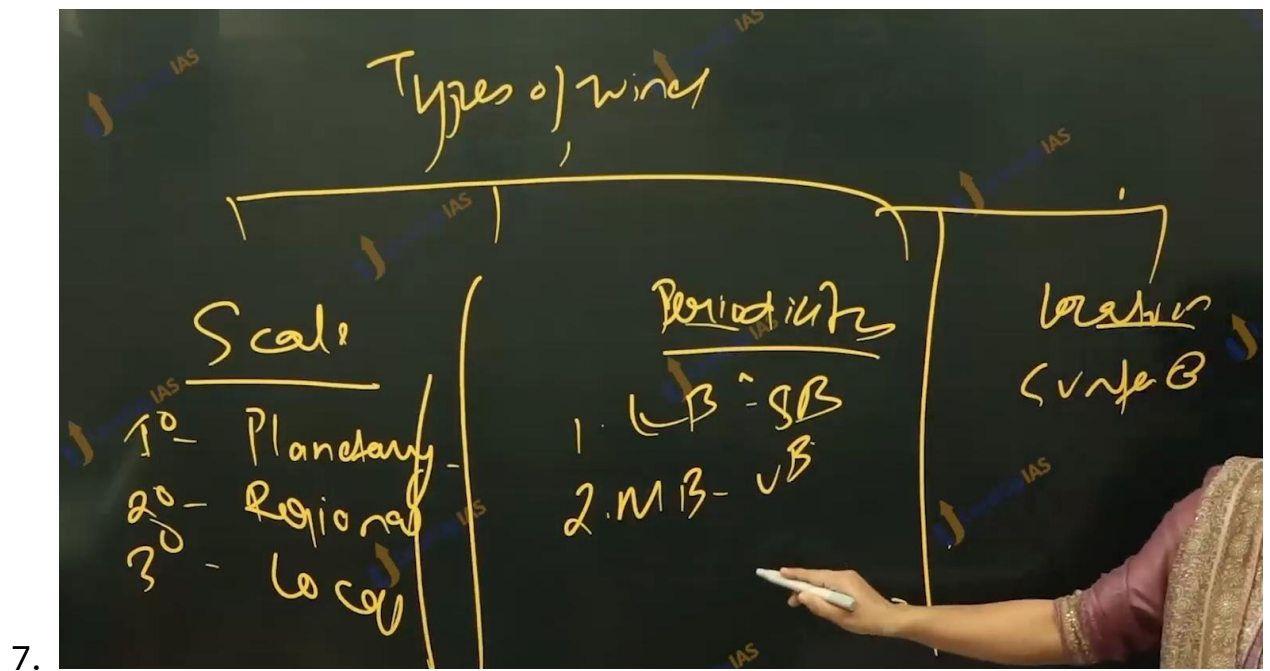
1. Rotation of earth affects the direction of the wind. This force is called the Coriolis force after the French physicist who described it in 1844.
2. It deflects the wind to the right direction in the northern hemisphere and to the left in the southern hemisphere.
3. The Coriolis force is directly proportional to the angle of latitude. It is maximum at the poles and is absent at the equator. It is apparent force
4. The deflection is more when the wind velocity is high.
5. The higher the pressure gradient force, the more is the velocity of the wind and the larger is the deflection in the direction of wind.
6. The Coriolis force acts perpendicular to the pressure gradient force
7. As a result of these two forces operating perpendicular to each other, in the low-pressure areas the wind blows around it. At the equator, the Coriolis force is zero and the wind blows perpendicular to the isobars. The low pressure gets filled instead of getting intensified. That is the reason why tropical cyclones are not formed at the equator.



5. FRICTIONAL FORCE:

- a. Frictional force affects the speed of winds. It retards / reduces the speed of winds
 - b. Frictional force is greater at the surface and influence of frictional force is generally 1 to 3 km.
 - c. Over the sea surface the frictional is minimums and therefore the there fore speed of winds is maximum in water.
-

6. Type of winds:



Type of winds :

1. On basis of scale

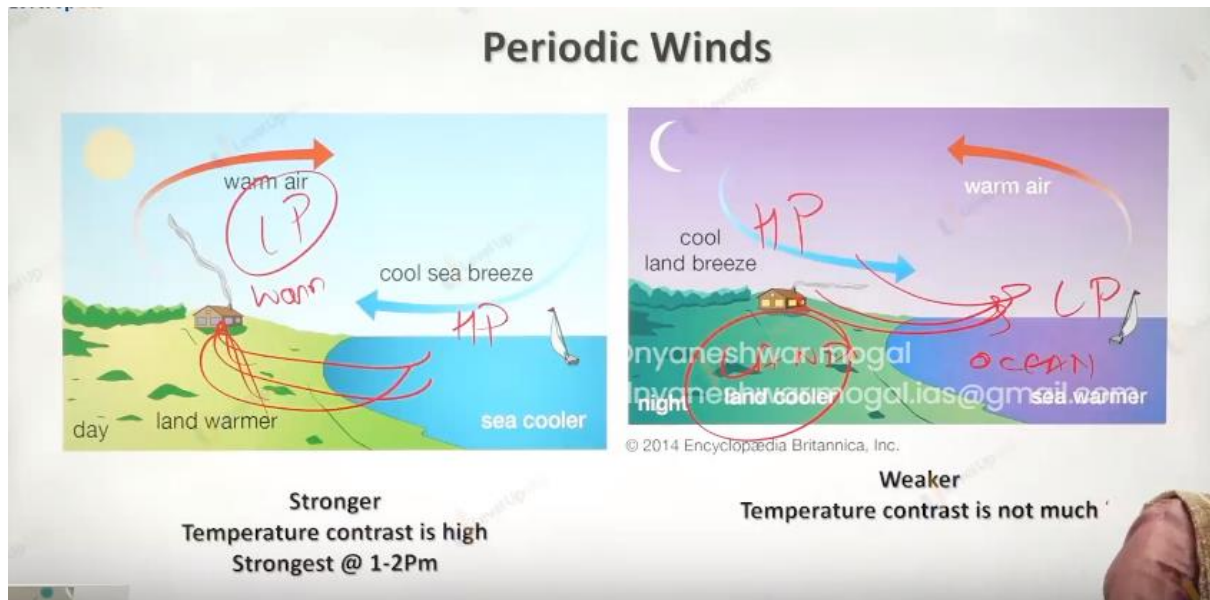
- a. Primary winds
- b. Secondary winds
- c. Tertiary winds

2. Based on location

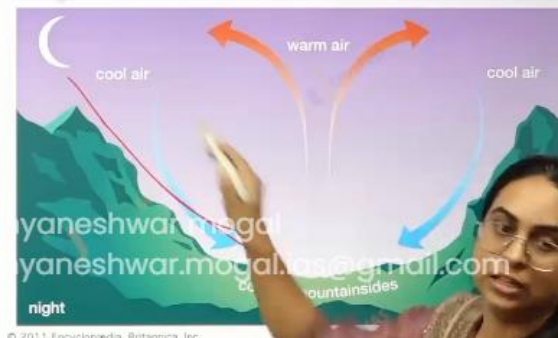
- a. Surface winds
- b. Aloft winds

3. On basis of periodicity

- a. Permanent winds
- b. Periodic winds
- c.



Valley and mountain breezes



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level up IAS



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2011

In the context of ecosystem productivity, marine upwelling zones are important as they increase the marine productivity by bringing the?

1. Decomposer microorganisms to the surface.
2. Nutrients to the surface.
3. Bottom-dwelling organisms to the surface.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2.
- b) 2 only.
- c) 2 and 3.
- d) 1 only.

2015: Mains Question

dnyaneshwar.mogal.ias@gmail

Mumbai, Delhi, and Kolkata are the three megacities of the country but **air pollution** is a much more serious problem in Delhi as compared to the other two. Why is this so?

Answer:

- *Emissions from Vehicles:*
- *Stubble Burning:*
- *Geographic location:*
- *Winter pollution:*
- *Large-scale construction*

Thermal Power Plants and Industries

dnyaneshwar.mogal.ias@gmail

gmail.com

2013: Mains Question

Major hot deserts in the northern hemisphere are located between 20-30 degree latitudes and on the western side of the continents. Why?

Answer:

- **Along Sub-Tropical High Pressure Belts:** Air is descending less precipitation
 - Trade Winds blow **off-shore**.
 - **Presence of cold currents:** Desiccating effect of the **cold Peruvian Current** along the Chilean coast is so pronounced that the mean annual rainfall for the Atacama Desert is not more than 1.3 cm.
-